



THE MARKET CAN LOSE ITS SHINE. GOLD WON'T.

Given the current market scenario, there's no better time to invest in gold. This precious metal that also makes for a trusted asset, will preserve the value of your investment for years to come.

WORLD GOLD COUNCIL



BITE Coverstory **BUDGET ASSESSMENT**

development there is no increase in real terms in National Rural Employment Guarantee Act and other programmes. You don't expect more demand push from that. So, basically at least till next year, we are banking on revival of agriculture from negative to positive.

Kumar: Demand impetus comes from consumption, government or private; investment, government or private; or exports. On government consumption, the trend is down because the expenditure hike is much less compared to last year. It is 8.9 per cent compared to 15.5 per cent and if you look at third quarter it is actually negative. That's the trend going to be. You have got to have fiscal funding. So, that source of demand is gone. On private consumption the only thing you have done is the tax slab change which releases Rs 52,000 a year for people with income up to Rs 10 lakh. This is much weaker than the demand impetus you have got from the farm loan waiver of Rs 60,000 crore and the 6th Pay Commission that you dished out. So, compared to the previous year, I don't see any extra oomph or impetus in consumption coming.

Goyal: If I have to make a point, I agree with



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Lowering of taxes was a nice surprise. Despite very challenging fiscal conditions, the Finance Ministry has actually cut taxes. That's the big message.

The finance minister could have announced FDI in insurance and retail. Since he has talked of entry of new banks, he could have highlighted steps to address capital shortage in PSU banks.

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